

Keith Dimech

Chief Operating Officer



GDAC-SA Tender Role: Chief Operating Officer | Database Development Expert | 2024 Victorian Infrastructure Award Winner | Industry Leadership (AWA, Beyond Zero)

Chief Operating Officer - Environment and Sustainability Manager

GDAC-SA Tender Role

Chief Operating Officer | Database Development Expert | 2024 Victorian Infrastructure Award Winner | Industry Leadership (AWA, Beyond Zero)

Current Positions

Chief Operating Officer (COO)

Lithodat Pty Ltd | Melbourne, Australia 2019 - Present (6+ years)

- Oversee all operational aspects of the company
- Lead GDAC-SA tender preparation and submission
- Manage client relationships and project delivery
- Database development and data management strategy
- Business development and strategic partnerships
- Financial planning and operational efficiency

Environment and Sustainability Manager

John Holland Water | Melbourne, Australia September 2021 - Present (3+ years)

- Developed and rolled out the Project Pathway to Net Zero Sustainability strategy for John Holland and Melbourne Water, now utilised across multiple projects and contractors
- Environmental and Sustainability Manager for Hobsons Bay Main and Western Treatment Plant RRRC projects, with a combined project value of \$900 million
- Winner of the 2024 Victorian Infrastructure Project Innovation Award - Australian Water Association
- Embedded in the corporate Environment and Sustainability team, undertaking policy writing, tendering, auditing and compliance
- Authorship of the ISO 9001 and 14001 accredited - Environmental, Sustainability and Safety Management Plan / Policy / Procedures
- Member of the HSEQ leadership team, including times as acting Safety Manager
- Ensuring the project achieves and abides by all approvals from various regulators required
- Delivered Australia's First Carbon Neutral Project - led the team to ensure lowest possible carbon emissions onsite through use of new technologies, sustainability through design and detailed materials tracking

Major Awards & Recognition

2024 Victorian Infrastructure Project Innovation Award

Australian Water Association (AWA)

- Recognized for innovative approaches to environmental data management on infrastructure projects
- Implemented novel database systems for tracking environmental compliance

2025 Australian Infrastructure Project Innovation Award

Australian Water Association (Finalist - Announced May 2025)

2025 Built Environment and Infrastructure

Banksia Award (Finalist - Announced April 2025)

Core Expertise

Sustainability Management

- Innovator in the management of digital construction material tracking and carbon accounting, developing a cloud-based SQL database to track material quantities and embodied carbon through project lifecycle
- Proficient in carbon accounting, social expenditure data collection, and regulatory reporting, including SBTi, Building Equality Policy, Indigenous Procurement Policy, and National Greenhouse Energy Reporting Scheme
- Founder of the Beyond Zero – Australian Water Association National Sustainability Specialist Network
- Deep knowledge of the Australian and International Carbon Credit Markets
- Embedding carbon into the cost planning, tendering, and quantity surveying decision-making procedures
- Prior member of the Low Carbon in Concrete Working Group with MTIA; strong understanding of new and emerging low-carbon construction materials, practices, and methods

Environmental Management

- Author of, and ensure compliance with, various environmental management plans, environmental permits, and procedures for cultural heritage, biodiversity, groundwater, contaminated land, noise, air quality and waste
- Extensive experience in approvals management, including EPAV, Council (Native Vegetation, Planning, Heritage Victoria, Traditional Owner Corporations), Parks Vic/DEECA, and Utilities
- Founder of an industry working group, applying for a CRC-P Grant and build a federal relational and geospatial database platform to store, analyse and report on federal environmental contamination and biodiversity data
- Deep knowledge in geotechnical field preparation and execution with a focus on soil and groundwater data collection; expert knowledge in contaminated land field works

Business Corporate Roles

- Corporate strategy, policy and procedure writing. Lead auditor and compliance manager across multiple projects
- Worked on, helped price large Energy, Water, Road and Rail Tenders, including successful bids for Northeast Link, Western Trunk Sewer, Resource Recovery & Reuse Complex, Suburban Rail Loop and Belmont Desalination Plant. Awaiting results on Tarraleah Hydroelectric upgrade, Aurora Treatment Plant and Healesville Treatment Plant
- Management, forecasting and budgeting of multiple million-dollar packages, including environment and sustainability expenses, construction and operation of water treatment plants and spoil cartage and disposal
- Tender, scope, and manage dozens of subcontracts valued between \$10k - \$2m
- 4 Direct reports and in the leadership group of a construction team of 55
- Skilled public speaker and presenter, engaging in industry events, podcasts, community forums, client briefings, stakeholder meetings, toolbox talks, and inductions

Industry Leadership Roles

Committee Member

Australian Water Association (AWA) | Victoria 2024 - 2026

- Victorian Branch Committee Member contributing to industry standards and best practices
- Participate in technical committees on data management
- Networking and knowledge sharing across water industry
- Advocate for innovation in environmental compliance

Founder

Beyond Zero – Australian Water Association National Sustainability Specialist Network 2018 - Present

- Lead sustainability initiatives in construction industry
- Develop frameworks for carbon-neutral infrastructure projects
- Engage with government and industry stakeholders
- Drive adoption of environmental best practices

Lead Applicant

Diagnostic Environmental Reporting Tool – CRC-P Grant 2025

- Applying for federal grant to build relational and geospatial database platform
- Store, analyse and report on federal environmental contamination and biodiversity data
- Establish industry working group for environmental data management

Prior Member

Low Carbon Concrete Working Group – MTIA

- Contributed to development of low-carbon construction materials and practices
- Industry collaboration on sustainability standards

Professional Experience

Senior Environmental Advisor

Clough (Clough Salini Joint Venture) | Snowy Hydro 2.0 Project, NSW *January 2021 - July 2021*

- Senior advisory role with the managing contractor on the \$5.1 billion renewable energy project in NSW being delivered on behalf of the Federal Government and Snowy Hydro Ltd
- Implementation of the Biodiversity Management Plan – balancing construction needs with the conservation of sensitive flora and fauna within the National Park
- Key stakeholder management position – face-to-face coordination with the client (Snowy Hydro), impacted residents and inter-governmental agencies (NPWS, NSW-EPA, DPIE)
- Guide environmental approvals for construction teams to progress works within the Kosciusko National Park (KNP), including road and drainage design, erosion and sediment control planning and approvals, national park clearing permitting and risk mitigation for pollution and sensitive waterways
- Preparing, reviewing, and project managing the implementation of large-scale Erosion and Sediment Control Plans, drainage, and sediment basin construction as per Blue Book specifications
- Managing the ground and surface-water ESDAT chemical database for the Snowy 2.0 Project, required for the upkeep under the Environmental Protection Licence

Environmental Coordinator

John Holland / Bouygues / Lendlease JV | Melbourne Metro Tunnel Project *January 2018 - December 2020*

- Work with key stakeholders including the City of Melbourne, EPA-Vic and Heritage Victoria to ensure planning approval and community consultation prior to staged construction works; ongoing engagement with impacted stakeholders in the CBD including presentations to community reference groups
- Managed environmental monitoring systems, including telemetered noise, air, and dust monitors across CBD sites
- Project managing large groundwater, surface-water and soil contamination monitoring events
- Successful approvals and excavation of twelve Heritage Inventory archaeological digs, the biggest archaeological investigation in Victoria's history

Environment Engineer

WSP | Melbourne, Australia *2016 - 2018*

- Environmental engineering and consulting
- Project management and stakeholder engagement
- Environmental impact assessments and approvals

Environmental Technician

Enqip | Melbourne, Australia *2015 - 2016*

- Environmental monitoring and field work
- Data collection and reporting
- Contaminated land investigations

Geologist

Minerals and Metals Group (MMG) *2011 - 2013*

- Geological field work and exploration
- Data analysis and geological mapping
- Mining industry experience

Education & Professional Development

Executive Master of Business Administration (EMBA)

RMIT University | Melbourne, Australia 2023 - 2025

- Corporate Finance & Corporate Accounting
- Creating Business Strategies & Innovation in a Global Context
- Design Thinking & Marketing
- Ethical Leadership and Business Research Design
- Managing Business Operations & Executive Consulting

Bachelor of Science (Honours) - Geophysics

University of Melbourne | Melbourne, Australia 2014

- Honours degree in Geophysics
- Research and thesis completion

Bachelor of Science - Geology

University of Melbourne | Melbourne, Australia 2009 - 2011

- Major in Geology
- Strong foundation in Earth Sciences

Technical Skills

- **Database Development:** PostgreSQL, SQL, cloud-based database systems, geospatial databases, ESDAT chemical database management
- **Programming:** Python, SQL query optimization, database design, data analysis
- **Environmental Systems:** ISO 9001 and 14001 accredited systems, environmental management plans, sustainability frameworks
- **Data Management:** Construction material tracking, carbon accounting systems, environmental monitoring data
- **Sustainability:** Carbon accounting, embodied carbon tracking, SBTi, National Greenhouse Energy Reporting Scheme
- **GIS & Spatial Analysis:** Geospatial database platforms, spatial data analysis
- **Regulatory Compliance:** EPAV, Heritage Victoria, Traditional Owner approvals, EPA licensing
- **Project Management:** Tender preparation, budget management, subcontract management, team leadership

Certifications & Training

- **ISO 14001 Environmental Management Systems** - Lead Auditor
- **Blue Book** - Erosion and sediment control training
- **Construction White Card**
- **First Aid / Mental Health First Aid Certificate**

Publications & Presentations

- **“Project Pathway to Net Zero”** - Oz Water 2025 Technical Paper
- Multiple industry presentations and conference talks
- Podcasts on sustainability and environmental management
- Community forums and stakeholder briefings

Professional Memberships

- Australian Water Association (AWA) - Victorian Branch Committee Member (2024-2026)
- Environment Institute of Australia & New Zealand (EIANZ)
- Engineers Australia

Referees

James Le - Client Representative +61 429 230 466 Senior Project Manager - Melbourne Water

James Braham - Previous Manager +61 418 915 754 National Environment and Sustainability Manager - Downer

Relevance to GDAC-SA Tender

- **Database Expertise:** Advanced SQL and cloud-based database development skills - directly applicable to building GDAC geological database platform. Proven track record developing innovative environmental data tracking systems
- **Award-Winning Innovation:** 2024 Victorian Infrastructure Innovation Award validates approach to data management and digital systems on large-scale infrastructure projects
- **Full-Stack Experience:** Experience building complete database systems from concept to deployment, including geospatial capabilities
- **Operational Leadership:** COO role at Lithodat demonstrates ability to manage complex operations and deliver on strategic objectives while simultaneously managing major infrastructure projects
- **Dual Role Success:** Successfully managing both Lithodat COO duties and John Holland Environment Manager role shows exceptional time management, organizational skills, and work capacity
- **Major Infrastructure Experience:** Deep understanding of large-scale infrastructure projects (\$900 million combined project value) with government stakeholders and regulatory compliance
- **Tender Experience:** Extensive experience pricing and winning major government tenders (Northeast Link, Western Trunk Sewer, Suburban Rail Loop, etc.) - directly applicable to GDAC-SA tender process
- **Industry Leadership:** AWA Victorian Branch Committee membership, Beyond Zero founder, and CRC-P Grant lead applicant demonstrates thought leadership and industry connections
- **Environmental Data Systems:** Proven expertise in environmental monitoring databases and regulatory reporting systems provides relevant experience for geological survey data management
- **Stakeholder Management:** Exceptional ability to engage with government agencies, regulators, clients (Melbourne Water), and industry stakeholders - critical for GDAC-SA success
- **Executive Education:** Pursuing Executive MBA at RMIT demonstrates commitment to business excellence and strategic thinking
- **Carbon Neutral Delivery:** Led Australia's First Carbon Neutral Project - demonstrates innovation, sustainability leadership, and ability to deliver groundbreaking outcomes
- **Database Innovation:** Developed cloud-based SQL database for construction material tracking and carbon accounting - shows ability to create innovative digital solutions for complex data management challenges